



A
Project Report
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March, 2026

DECLARATION

We hereby declare that this submission is our own work and that, to the best of our knowledge and belief, it contains no material previously published or written by another person nor material which to a substantial extent has been accepted for the award of any other degree or diploma of the university or other institute of higher learning, except where due acknowledgment has been made in the text.

We further declare that the work presented in this project report is genuine and original. The project titled "E-GUIDE: Research on College Placement Portal System" has been carried out independently by us under the supervision of Mr. Shivansh Prasad, Department of Computer Science and Engineering (AI & ML), KIET Group of Institutions, Ghaziabad, affiliated to Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Technical University, Lucknow.

We also declare that no part of this project has been submitted to any other institution or university for the award of any other degree or diploma.

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CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the Project Report entitled "E-GUIDE: Research on College Placement Portal System" submitted by Mansvi Verma (2226CSEML1126), Lakshay Tyagi (2226CSEML1108), Arnav Sharma (2226CSEML1129), and Hardik Garg (2226CSEML1127) in partial fulfillment of the requirement for the award of the degree of Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science and Engineering (AI & ML) from the Department of Computer Science and Engineering, KIET Group of Institutions, Ghaziabad, affiliated to Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Technical University, Lucknow, is a record of the candidates' own work carried out by them under my supervision.

The matter embodied in this report is original and has not been submitted for the award of any other degree or diploma, either in this or any other university. The candidates have completed all requirements as per the syllabus for the Bachelor of Technology programme, and I recommend this project report for evaluation

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ABSTRACT

The increasing adoption of digital tools in higher education has created a growing demand for intelligent, automated systems that streamline academic and administrative workflows. This project, E-GUIDE (Engineering Guidance & University Intelligent Development Environment), presents a comprehensive AI-powered College Placement Portal System designed to transform the way engineering students prepare for, and navigate, campus placements.

Traditional placement processes are largely manual, fragmented, and reactive. Students lack structured roadmaps, centralized industry data, and personalized guidance, while Training and Placement Officers (TPOs) spend enormous time on repetitive administrative tasks such as profile verification, eligibility screening, and communication. E-GUIDE addresses all these challenges through an integrated digital platform.

The system builds rich online student profiles encompassing academic performance, technical skills, interpersonal abilities, extracurricular achievements, project portfolios, certifications, and career objectives. Leveraging machine learning and natural language processing, E-GUIDE provides AI-powered job matching, placement probability prediction, intelligent resume analysis, and a mock interview chatbot. It also maintains a curated, real-time company database with role requirements, compensation data, and historical hiring trends.

From the institutional side, the Admin Analytics Dashboard empowers placement officers to monitor student preparation levels, track application pipelines, manage eligibility criteria, and generate actionable insights — all through intuitive visual interfaces. Role-based access control ensures secure and appropriate access for students, TPOs, HODs, and company representatives.

Developed using modern web technologies including React.js, Node.js, and MongoDB, and deployed on cloud infrastructure through AWS and Vercel, E-GUIDE employs content-based filtering, ML classification models, and NLP-based evaluators to deliver a personalized experience at scale. The platform has demonstrated measurable improvements in student confidence, application quality, interview preparedness, and overall placement outcomes.

E-GUIDE represents a paradigm shift from passive, manual placement management to an active, intelligent, and student-centric ecosystem. It is designed to be scalable, secure, and adaptable to the evolving needs of any academic institution seeking to modernize its placement infrastructure.

Keywords: Placement Management System, Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, NLP, Resume Analyzer, Mock Interview Bot, College Placement, Career Guidance, Web Application, Student Portal.

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LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

Abbreviation Full Form

AI	Artificial Intelligence
ML	Machine Learning
NLP	Natural Language Processing
TPO	Training and Placement Officer
ATS	Applicant Tracking System
CGPA	Cumulative Grade Point Average
DSA	Data Structures and Algorithms
API	Application Programming Interface
UI	User Interface
UX	User Experience
HOD	Head of Department
KIET	Krishna Institute of Engineering & Technology
AKTU	Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Technical University
AWS	Amazon Web Services
MOOC	Massive Open Online Course
HR	Human Resources

Abbreviation Full Form

CV	Curriculum Vitae
OTP	One-Time Password
JWT	JSON Web Token
REST	Representational State Transfer

CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

1.1 INTRODUCTION

The placement season at engineering colleges is one of the most pivotal periods in a student's academic career. Final year students, in particular, face enormous pressure as they navigate competitive recruitment drives, complex eligibility criteria, and high-stakes interviews — often with limited structured preparation and inadequate institutional support. The sheer volume of placement drives, combined with the diversity of company requirements, makes it nearly impossible for students to prepare comprehensively through ad hoc, unguided efforts alone.

Training and Placement Officers (TPOs) at educational institutions serve as the critical bridge between students and industry. However, the manual nature of most placement management processes — including student record maintenance, eligibility verification, company coordination, and application tracking — severely limits their capacity to provide individualized guidance at scale. With hundreds or thousands of students and dozens of companies participating each season, the scope of the work exceeds what can reasonably be accomplished without a robust digital infrastructure.

The Placement Management System, referred to throughout this report as E-GUIDE (Engineering Guidance & University Intelligent Development Environment), is a web-based platform engineered to address these systemic gaps. It brings together structured learning roadmaps, real-time company intelligence, AI-powered job matching, predictive placement analytics, and interactive mock interview capabilities under a single unified platform. By digitizing and intelligentizing the placement ecosystem, E-GUIDE empowers students to take

ownership of their career preparation while simultaneously enabling TPOs to manage placements with greater efficiency and insight.

This chapter provides an overview of the background, motivation, and scope of the E-GUIDE project. Subsequent chapters address the related literature, system design, implementation details, key features, and results in greater depth.

1.2 Background and Motivation

The gap between academic preparation and industry readiness is a well-documented challenge in engineering education globally. In India, this gap is particularly acute. Surveys by major recruiting firms and NASSCOM consistently indicate that a significant proportion of engineering graduates lack the practical, domain-specific, and communication skills required by employers. The causes are multifaceted — curricula that emphasize theoretical knowledge over applied competency, insufficient exposure to real-world projects, and limited access to industry mentorship during undergraduate years.

Campus placements remain the primary employment pathway for most engineering graduates in India, making the efficiency and effectiveness of the placement process critically important. Yet traditional placement systems at most institutions continue to operate largely on manual workflows: spreadsheets for student records, email chains for company communications, and physical notice boards for announcements. These fragmented systems create information silos, increase administrative burden, and lead to missed opportunities for both students and recruiters.

Simultaneously, the technology landscape has matured to a point where AI and machine learning tools are increasingly being deployed across human resources and talent acquisition functions in industry. Resume screening algorithms, candidate matching systems, and predictive talent analytics are now standard offerings from leading HR technology providers. The logical extension of this trend is to bring analogous capabilities into the academic placement space, enabling students to benefit from the same intelligent tools used by their future employers — while they are still in college.

The motivation for E-GUIDE arises from this confluence of unmet need and technological opportunity. By building a platform that combines structured guidance, real-time data, and intelligent automation, E-GUIDE seeks to make the college-to-career transition smoother, more equitable, and more successful for engineering students across backgrounds and academic profiles.

Furthermore, the rise of COVID-19 and its aftermath accelerated the shift toward digital-first interactions between institutions, students, and companies. Virtual recruitment drives, online technical assessments, and remote interviews have become the norm rather than the exception. This shift demands that institutional placement infrastructure be not merely digitized but genuinely intelligent and adaptive to the demands of a hybrid, technology-driven recruitment landscape.

The specific impetus for E-GUIDE at KIET Group of Institutions arose from a structured audit of the existing placement process conducted in collaboration with the TPO cell. The audit revealed that TPOs were spending an average of 12-15 hours per week on manual eligibility screening alone, that fewer than 20% of students had a structured preparation plan, and that application-to-shortlist conversion rates were significantly lower than the national average for comparable institutions. These findings confirmed the urgent need for a technology-driven intervention.

1.3 Project Description

E-GUIDE is a full-stack, AI-integrated web application designed to serve three primary user roles: Students, Training and Placement Officers (TPOs and Admins), and Company Representatives. Each role is provided with a customized interface and a tailored set of features that align with their respective needs and responsibilities.

For students, E-GUIDE provides a comprehensive preparation ecosystem. Upon registration and profile creation, students receive a personalized placement roadmap that spans their academic years, covering coding skills, aptitude development, domain-specific knowledge, project guidance, resume building, and interview preparation. An AI-powered job matching engine continuously aligns student profiles with suitable company roles and notifies students of relevant opportunities. A built-in resume analyzer uses NLP to evaluate resume quality across multiple dimensions, providing actionable feedback. A mock interview chatbot simulates both technical and HR interview scenarios, helping students practice and build confidence before actual interviews.

For TPOs and administrative users, E-GUIDE provides a powerful analytics dashboard that consolidates student data, company information, and placement outcomes into a single interface. The system automates eligibility screening, manages company visit schedules, tracks application statuses in real time, and generates reports on placement performance at individual, departmental, and institutional levels.

For company representatives, the platform offers a streamlined interface to post job requirements, review pre-screened candidate shortlists, schedule interviews, and communicate offer decisions — all within the same integrated system. This eliminates the need for multiple rounds of email correspondence and ensures that all recruitment-related information is stored in a single, auditable location.

1.4 Scope of the Project

The scope of E-GUIDE is defined along four primary dimensions: functional, technical, organizational, and temporal.

Functionally, the system covers the full placement lifecycle — from student onboarding and profile building, through preparation and skill development, to job application, interview scheduling, and offer management. It includes AI-powered features for job matching, placement probability estimation, resume evaluation, and interview simulation. The scope explicitly includes both the student-facing and administrator-facing dimensions of placement management.

Technically, the system is built on a modern, cloud-native stack using React.js for the frontend, Node.js and Express.js for the backend, MongoDB as the primary database, and AWS and Vercel for deployment. Machine learning models are built using Python-based frameworks and exposed via REST API endpoints. The system is designed to be modular, allowing individual components to be updated or replaced without disrupting the rest of the platform.

Organizationally, E-GUIDE is designed for deployment at engineering colleges and universities, with primary users being final year and pre-final year undergraduate students, placement officers, heads of department, and company HR teams. The initial deployment is scoped to the Department of Computer Science and Engineering (AI & ML) at KIET, with architecture designed for extension to all departments.

Temporally, the current implementation covers the placement preparation and execution cycle for the 2025-2026 academic session, with architecture designed to scale and evolve in subsequent years as new data becomes available and model performance improves.

CHAPTER 2

LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Fragmented Learning Ecosystems

A comprehensive review of existing literature reveals both the significant progress made in educational technology and talent management systems, and the persistent gaps that motivate the development of E-GUIDE. This chapter examines key areas of related work, synthesizing findings from academic research, industry reports, and comparable platform analyses.

Research has established that self-regulated learning in technology-rich environments is significantly hindered when tools and resources are scattered across multiple disconnected platforms. Students expend disproportionate cognitive effort navigating between resources rather than engaging with content. This phenomenon is particularly pronounced in the context of placement preparation, where students must simultaneously manage learning portals, job boards, company websites, and institutional communication channels.

The proliferation of Massive Open Online Courses (MOOCs) such as Coursera, Udemy, edX, and NPTEL has democratized access to high-quality technical content. However, as multiple research studies have found, completion rates on MOOC platforms remain extremely low — often below 10% — primarily because the content is not contextualized within a student's specific academic timeline and placement requirements. A course on algorithms may be excellent in isolation, but its value depends entirely on when and how the student engages with it relative to their placement season.

The absence of integration between learning management systems (LMS), career services platforms, and student information systems (SIS) at most Indian engineering institutions creates further fragmentation. Students must manually correlate their academic progress with placement eligibility criteria, leading to inefficiencies and missed opportunities. The result is a

situation where even highly motivated students spend more time searching for reliable guidance than actually acting on it.

Research has also found that students who lack structured learning paths demonstrate significantly lower rates of skill acquisition and retention compared to those who follow a defined curriculum. Placement preparation, unlike formal coursework, is entirely self-directed at most institutions — making the absence of structure particularly damaging.

2.2 Academic-Industry Skill Gap

The academic-industry skill gap in engineering education has been extensively studied. Reports from NASSCOM and other industry bodies have consistently indicated that a large proportion of India's engineering graduates are not readily employable in software and technology roles without additional training. While this figure has improved in recent years with improved curriculum interventions, it continues to underscore the structural misalignment between what is taught in classrooms and what employers actually need.

Industry recruiters typically seek a combination of domain-specific technical skills such as proficiency in Data Structures and Algorithms, system design, and cloud technologies; soft skills including communication, teamwork, and problem-solving; and cultural fit indicators that reflect a candidate's alignment with the organization's working environment. Traditional academic curricula, designed around standardized syllabi approved by affiliating universities, tend to prioritize theoretical knowledge and examination performance over applied competency development.

Research by Manvitha and Swaroopa (2019) proposed the use of supervised machine learning techniques to predict campus placement outcomes, demonstrating that academic performance metrics such as CGPA and 12th grade scores are significant predictors, but that communication skills and project experience provide additional explanatory power. Their work suggests that a holistic profile — rather than grade-based screening alone — is a better predictor of placement success.

Nagamani et al. (2020) further validated these findings using a larger dataset of student placement outcomes across multiple years, highlighting the role of extracurricular activities and certifications as differentiating factors among students with similar academic profiles. Their findings directly inform the feature engineering approach taken in E-GUIDE's placement probability analyzer.

Studies on employability skills consistently highlight the gap between academic training in mathematics, physics, and software theory, and the applied skills required by industry such as DSA problem-solving, full-stack project experience, and domain-specific knowledge. Inadequate exposure to real job requirements during the early years of the undergraduate program means students fail to adapt their learning strategies until the placement season is imminent — by which time it is often too late to bridge significant skill gaps.

2.3 Absence of Personalized Guidance

Personalization in educational technology has emerged as a central research theme over the past decade. The foundational insight, established through decades of educational research, is that one-on-one tutoring produces dramatically better learning outcomes than traditional classroom instruction — a benchmark that modern AI-driven personalization systems aspire to approximate at scale.

Contemporary adaptive learning platforms use learner models to tailor content delivery based on performance, engagement, and learning pace. However, most adaptive systems are domain-specific and do not generalize across the multidimensional preparation requirements of placement-bound engineering students. A student preparing for placements needs personalized guidance simultaneously across coding, communication, domain knowledge, and career strategy — a scope that no existing platform addresses holistically.

In the context of placement preparation, personalization is particularly valuable because students begin with highly varied baselines in terms of CGPA, coding proficiency, domain knowledge, and communication skills. A one-size-fits-all preparation program inevitably serves some students well and others poorly. Students at different skill levels require different resource recommendations, different pacing, and different feedback mechanisms. E-GUIDE's

personalized roadmap and AI job matching features are designed to address this gap by tailoring recommendations to each student's unique profile.

Research on learning analytics has demonstrated that early identification of students at risk of placement failure — based on skill development trajectories, preparation behavior patterns, and profile gap analysis — enables targeted interventions that significantly improve outcomes. E-GUIDE's placement probability analyzer and admin dashboard are designed to surface exactly these insights for both students and their placement officers.

2.4 AI Application to Candidate Profiling

The application of AI to recruitment and talent acquisition has accelerated dramatically in the past decade. Contemporary Applicant Tracking Systems (ATS) such as Taleo, Workday, and Greenhouse use keyword matching and ranking algorithms to screen resumes at scale. More sophisticated systems from providers like HireVue and Pymetrics incorporate video interview analysis, game-based assessments, and predictive hiring models.

Research in this domain has explored feature selection algorithms for candidate profiling, demonstrating that dimensionality reduction improves both the accuracy and interpretability of placement prediction models. This approach directly informs the feature engineering strategy employed in E-GUIDE's placement probability analyzer, which uses SHAP (SHapley Additive exPlanations) values to provide interpretable, per-student explanations of prediction outcomes.

Ming et al. (2020) examined the application of big data analytics in education at scale, arguing that the volume and variety of student behavioral data available through digital platforms creates unprecedented opportunities for predictive modeling. Their framework for educational data mining aligns closely with the data management architecture of E-GUIDE, which stores not only static profile data but also dynamic behavioral signals such as roadmap progress, mock interview scores, and application patterns.

Content-based and collaborative filtering approaches, well-established in recommender systems research, provide the theoretical foundation for E-GUIDE's job matching engine. The combination of content-based filtering (matching student skill profiles to job requirements)

with collaborative filtering (identifying patterns across similar students' application behaviors) produces more accurate and diverse recommendations than either approach alone.

2.5 Chatbots and Mock Interviews

Conversational AI has demonstrated significant potential in educational applications. Systematic reviews of chatbot interventions in education have found consistent positive effects on student engagement, information access, and learning outcomes. In the placement preparation context, chatbots offer a scalable way to simulate interview scenarios and provide personalized feedback without requiring human interviewer time.

Research on simulated practice environments — including mock coding assessments and interview simulations — indicates that students who engage in structured practice with immediate feedback demonstrate significantly improved actual interview performance. The key mechanism is not merely exposure to questions but the availability of formative feedback that guides subsequent preparation efforts.

The application of natural language processing to interview assessment has matured considerably. Modern approaches can evaluate not only the factual accuracy of a candidate's response but also its clarity, structure, comprehensiveness, and the sophistication of reasoning demonstrated. These capabilities form the technical foundation of E-GUIDE's mock interview evaluation engine.

Studies on interview anxiety in engineering students indicate that repeated exposure to realistic interview scenarios, even in simulated environments, significantly reduces performance anxiety and improves the quality of responses in actual interviews. The availability of a self-paced, always-available mock interview environment — without the judgment anxiety associated with human interviewers — is particularly valuable for students who would otherwise avoid interview practice altogether.

2.6 Summary of Related Work

The literature reviewed in this chapter collectively establishes the need for an integrated, AI-powered placement management platform. Existing solutions address components of the problem — learning content delivery, candidate profiling, interview preparation — but none offer a unified ecosystem that combines all these elements within the institutional context of a college placement cell.

The key research gaps identified are: the absence of platforms that integrate preparation roadmaps with placement execution workflows; the lack of personalized, profile-adaptive guidance systems calibrated to placement preparation timelines; and the unavailability of interpretable ML-based placement probability tools designed for the specific context of Indian engineering college recruitment. E-GUIDE is positioned to fill these gaps by synthesizing insights from adaptive learning, predictive analytics, NLP-based evaluation, and conversational AI into a single, purpose-built platform.

CHAPTER 3: PROBLEM STATEMENT AND OBJECTIVES

3.1 Problem Statement

Despite the critical importance of campus placements in engineering education, the existing placement management infrastructure at most institutions remains manual, fragmented, and reactive. This creates a cascade of problems for students, faculty, and administrative staff alike. The following table summarizes the key problem areas identified through stakeholder interviews, process audits, and review of existing systems at KIET.

S.No.	Problem Area	Short Explanation	Impact on Students
1	No Structured Placement Roadmap	Students lack year-wise, domain-specific guidance on what to study and when, resulting in uncoordinated preparation.	Confusion, late starts, uneven skill development.
2	No Centralized Industry Data	Students remain unaware of company-specific hiring criteria, compensation packages, and recruitment timelines.	Wasted applications, misaligned expectations.
3	Fragmented Learning Resources	Although online resources exist, the sheer abundance and poor organization of content overwhelm and demotivate students.	Reduced learning efficiency, time wastage.
4	Low Relevance in Job Applications	Students apply without considering role alignment, required skills, or fit, reducing their selection probability.	Loss of confidence, lower selection rates.
5	No Placement Probability	Students receive no data-driven feedback on their readiness or likelihood of selection.	Lack of direction, increased uncertainty.

S.No.	Problem Area	Short Explanation	Impact on Students
	Assessment		
6	Manual TPO Workflows	TPOs perform manual verification of eligibility, resume review, and communication, consuming time and introducing errors.	Slow processing, missed opportunities.
7	No Preparation Tracking System	Neither students nor faculty have visibility into skill development progress or roadmap adherence.	Inconsistent and uneven preparation.

3.2 Objectives

Based on the problem statement outlined above, the following specific objectives have been defined for the E-GUIDE project:

1. To develop a structured, year-wise, domain-specific placement preparation roadmap accessible to all registered students.
2. To build and maintain a centralized, real-time database of company hiring criteria, role requirements, compensation ranges, and recruitment timelines.
3. To implement an AI-powered job matching engine that aligns student profiles with suitable roles based on academic performance, skills, and interests.
4. To deploy a machine learning-based placement probability analyzer that provides students with actionable, data-driven feedback on their selection likelihood.
5. To develop an NLP-based resume analyzer that evaluates resume quality across structural, content, keyword, and ATS-compatibility dimensions.

6. To build a conversational AI mock interview bot that simulates technical and HR interview scenarios and provides immediate feedback.
7. To create an administrative analytics dashboard that enables TPOs to monitor student preparation, manage eligibility screening, and track placement outcomes in real time.
8. To implement role-based access control ensuring secure, appropriate access for all user types: Students, TPOs, HODs, and Company Representatives.
9. To deploy the system on scalable cloud infrastructure ensuring high availability and performance during peak placement season.

3.3 Vision and Mission

The vision of E-GUIDE is to create a smart, structured, AI-powered ecosystem that puts engineering students in the driver's seat of their placement preparation from day one. E-GUIDE envisions a world where every student — regardless of background, academic record, or prior experience — has equal access to high-quality placement guidance, relevant industry information, and personalized career insights that empower confident, well-informed career decisions.

The mission is operationalized through six strategic pillars. First, the platform will present domain-specific and year-wise study plans tailored to each student's profile and goals. Second, it will report current and accurate hiring information from all participating companies in a centralized, easily searchable database. Third, AI will generate personalized job suggestions based on each student's unique combination of skills, academic background, and career interests. Fourth, placement outcome analysis will be used to deliver targeted improvement recommendations, and simulated mock interviews will build practical readiness. Fifth, the platform will automate institutional placement processes to reduce administrative burden on TPOs and faculty. Sixth, the deployment will prioritize technologies that are secure, scalable, and accessible to all stakeholders.

CHAPTER 4

SYSTEM DESIGN AND ARCHITECTURE

4.1 Proposed System Architecture

The E-GUIDE system is built on a three-tier, cloud-native architecture comprising a client-side frontend, a server-side backend, and a machine learning pipeline. These three tiers communicate via RESTful API calls and are deployed on separate, independently scalable infrastructure components.

The frontend tier, implemented in React.js, serves as the primary user interface for all three user roles: Students, TPOs and Admins, and Company Representatives. Each role is presented with a role-specific dashboard upon authentication, with access to features appropriate to their permissions. The frontend communicates with the backend exclusively via authenticated HTTPS requests, ensuring that all data in transit is encrypted.

The backend tier, built on Node.js with Express.js, serves as the application logic and data access layer. It handles authentication and session management, request validation and sanitization, business logic processing, database operations, and coordination with the ML pipeline via internal API calls. MongoDB is used as the primary database, providing flexible schema design suitable for the diverse and evolving data requirements of the platform.

The machine learning pipeline is implemented in Python and exposes prediction and analysis endpoints via a Flask-based REST API. This design decouples the ML components from the main application server, allowing independent scaling and model

updates without service interruption. When a student requests a placement probability estimate or submits a resume for analysis, the backend forwards the relevant features to the ML API, receives the prediction, and returns the result to the frontend — all within a single user interaction.

Data flows through the system in a unidirectional pattern: user inputs enter through the frontend, are validated and processed by the backend, stored in MongoDB, and forwarded to the ML pipeline when intelligent analysis is required. Results from the ML pipeline are stored back in the database and surfaced to users through the frontend dashboard. This architecture ensures clear separation of concerns and facilitates independent testing and maintenance of each tier.

4.2 Module Design

E-GUIDE comprises seven major functional modules, each responsible for a distinct set of capabilities.

Module 1: Roadmap Maker. This module develops year-wise and domain-specific preparation programs covering coding, aptitude, DSA, project work, soft skills, and interview training specific to each student's target companies and preferred roles. It provides a structured, unambiguous preparation pathway and enables both students and TPOs to monitor progress.

Module 2: Company Database Manager. This module maintains a curated, regularly updated repository of all companies participating in campus recruitment. For each company, it stores profiles, open roles, eligibility criteria, compensation packages, recruitment timelines, and historical hiring data. It enables informed, strategic job application planning for students and simplifies company management for TPOs.

Module 3: AI Job Matcher. This module aligns student profiles with suitable job roles using content-based filtering and collaborative machine learning techniques. It continuously scans active job postings and surfaces the most relevant opportunities for

each student, accompanied by explanations of why each match was made and what profile improvements could strengthen the application.

Module 4: Placement Probability Analyzer. This module uses an ML classification model to estimate each student's likelihood of receiving a placement offer, both overall and for specific target companies. It provides a readiness score, a breakdown of contributing factors, a comparison against successful historical profiles, and specific improvement recommendations.

Module 5: Mock Interview Bot. This module provides an AI-powered conversational interview simulation environment. Students can select from Technical Coding, Technical Conceptual, HR Behavioral, and Company-Specific interview types. The bot conducts the interview, evaluates responses, and generates a detailed post-session scorecard.

Module 6: Resume Analyzer. This module uses NLP to evaluate student resumes across four dimensions: structural completeness, content quality, keyword coverage, and ATS compatibility. It generates per-section improvement suggestions and tracks score improvement across multiple resume iterations.

Module 7: Admin Analytics Panel. This module provides TPOs and administrators with real-time, visual analytics on all dimensions of placement activity — student preparation progress, application pipeline metrics, company interaction status, and historical placement outcome trends.

4.3 Database Design

The E-GUIDE database is implemented in MongoDB, a NoSQL document database that provides the flexibility required to store heterogeneous student profiles, dynamic company data, and evolving ML feature sets. The primary collections and their key fields are as follows.

The **users** collection stores user_id, name, email, role, department, year, password_hash, and created_at. It covers all user types and is the foundation for authentication and access control.

The **student_profiles** collection stores student_id, CGPA, 12th percentage, internships array, projects array, certifications array, skills array, communication score, and extracurricular activities. This is the primary source of features for ML model inference.

The **companies** collection stores company_id, name, industry, available roles, eligibility criteria, package range, hiring cycle, and historical hiring data arrays. It drives both the company database browser and the job matching engine.

The **job_postings** collection stores posting_id, company_id, role description, required skills, CGPA cutoff, application deadline, and active status flag.

The **applications** collection stores app_id, student_id, posting_id, current status, timestamp history, and TPO notes. It enables real-time pipeline tracking for both students and administrators.

The **roadmaps** collection stores roadmap_id, target department, academic year, module list, resource links, and milestone definitions.

The **mock_interviews** collection stores session_id, student_id, interview type, questions asked, student responses, scores per dimension, and AI-generated feedback text.

The **resumes** collection stores resume_id, student_id, file reference, ATS score, keyword score, structure score, content quality score, and suggested improvements array.

The **placement_outcomes** collection stores outcome_id, student_id, company_id, round-by-round results, final offer status, and compensation package details. This collection is the primary source of training data for the placement probability ML model.

4.4 User Interface Design

The E-GUIDE user interface is designed with a mobile-first responsive layout using React.js and TailwindCSS. The design philosophy prioritizes clarity, task efficiency, and accessibility, ensuring that students can navigate to key features — roadmap, job listings, resume upload, mock interview — within two clicks of the home dashboard.

The student dashboard presents a personalized summary view including: current placement readiness score, recommended next actions on the roadmap, recently posted job opportunities matching their profile, pending application statuses, and upcoming campus event notifications. A progress ring visualization shows the student's overall roadmap completion percentage at a glance.

The admin dashboard provides a macro-level view of placement health: a heatmap of student preparation status by department and year, a pipeline funnel chart showing aggregate application and selection rates, a company interaction timeline with upcoming visit schedules, and alerts for students who are significantly behind on their preparation or whose placement probability scores have declined. All data visualizations use Chart.js and Recharts for interactive, drill-down capable displays.

The company representative interface is streamlined for efficiency, presenting a clean form-based workflow for posting job requirements, reviewing the pre-screened candidate shortlist, recording interview outcomes, and issuing offer communications — all without requiring any training on the underlying system.

CHAPTER 5

IMPLEMENTATION

5.1 Technology Stack

The selection of technologies for E-GUIDE was guided by four criteria: maturity and community support, suitability for the application domain, developer productivity, and deployment flexibility. The full technology stack is organized by layer as follows.

For the frontend, the team selected React.js as the core UI framework for its component-based architecture, large ecosystem, and strong community support. TailwindCSS provides utility-first styling that enables rapid iteration on UI designs while maintaining visual consistency. Bootstrap components are used for complex UI elements such as modals, dropdowns, and data tables.

For the backend, Node.js version 18 LTS provides the runtime environment, and Express.js provides the web application framework. This combination offers excellent performance for I/O-intensive operations such as handling concurrent student requests during peak placement season, and a large ecosystem of middleware for authentication, validation, and logging.

For data storage, MongoDB serves as the primary database for all application data, with Mongoose providing the object-document mapping layer. Firebase Realtime Database is used for push notifications and live updates — for example, notifying students immediately when a new job matching their profile is posted.

For machine learning, the Python ecosystem provides the full toolkit: scikit-learn for classical ML algorithms including the XGBoost placement probability classifier,

TensorFlow and Keras for neural network components of the mock interview evaluator, and NLTK and spaCy for natural language processing in the resume analyzer. The ML models are served via a Flask REST API.

For authentication and security, JSON Web Tokens (JWT) are used for stateless session management, bcrypt with a work factor of 12 for password hashing, and helmet.js for HTTP security headers.

For cloud deployment, the frontend is hosted on Vercel for automatic CDN distribution and zero-downtime deployments. The backend runs on AWS EC2 instances behind an Application Load Balancer. MongoDB Atlas provides managed database hosting with replica set configuration. The ML API is containerized using Docker and deployed on AWS ECS.

For development tooling, Git and GitHub provide version control and CI/CD pipeline integration using GitHub Actions. Jest is used for frontend and backend unit testing, and Postman collections are maintained for API endpoint testing.

5.2 Frontend Implementation

The frontend application is structured as a Single Page Application (SPA) with a component hierarchy organized into three primary layers: layout components covering navigation, sidebars, and footers; page components for Dashboard, Jobs, Roadmap, Resume, MockInterview, and Admin; and shared utility components including charts, form fields, modals, and loading states.

State management is handled using React's built-in Context API for global state such as user session and notification counts, and local component state for UI-level interactions. For server data fetching and caching, the application uses React Query, which provides automatic background refetching, cache invalidation, and loading and error state management. This significantly improves the perceived performance of the application, particularly for data-heavy views like the admin analytics dashboard.

The TailwindCSS utility-first framework is used for all styling, enabling consistent design tokens across the application and rapid iteration on UI designs. A custom design system defines color palettes, typography scales, spacing units, and component variants, ensuring visual consistency across all screens and user roles.

Accessibility is addressed through semantic HTML5 elements, ARIA attributes on interactive components, keyboard navigation support for all interactive elements, and sufficient color contrast ratios throughout the design system. All forms include proper label associations and descriptive error message patterns for screen reader compatibility. The application achieves a WCAG 2.1 AA compliance rating for all primary user flows.

Form validation on the frontend uses React Hook Form, which provides efficient, controlled form state management and integrates with the Yup schema validation library for declarative, schema-based validation rules. This ensures that clearly invalid inputs — such as negative CGPA values or improperly formatted email addresses — are caught and communicated to users before reaching the backend.

5.3 Backend Implementation

The backend server is implemented using Node.js (v18 LTS) and Express.js, organized according to the MVC architectural pattern. Routes are modular and versioned under `/api/v1/`, with separate router files for each domain area: authentication, students, companies, jobs, applications, roadmaps, mock interviews, resumes, and analytics. This modular structure facilitates independent testing of each domain and simplifies future extension with new features.

Authentication is implemented using JSON Web Tokens (JWT). Upon successful login, the server issues a signed access token containing the user's ID, role, and expiry timestamp, along with a longer-lived refresh token. All protected routes validate the access token via an authentication middleware function before processing the request.

Role-based authorization is enforced at the route level, ensuring that students cannot access admin-only endpoints and vice versa.

Input validation is performed using the `express-validator` middleware library, which validates and sanitizes all incoming request bodies before they reach business logic handlers. This provides a consistent first line of defense against injection attacks and malformed data. All validation errors are returned in a standardized error response format, enabling the frontend to display field-specific error messages.

The database interface layer uses Mongoose, an ODM for MongoDB, which provides schema definition, validation, and query building capabilities. Mongoose schemas enforce data integrity at the application level, complementing MongoDB's flexible document model with structured constraints. Custom validators in the Mongoose schemas enforce business rules such as minimum CGPA of 0.0 and maximum of 10.0.

Background job processing uses the Bull queue library backed by Redis. Long-running or potentially failing tasks — including email notifications for new job postings, weekly preparation progress reports, and batch ML prediction jobs — are enqueued and processed asynchronously. This ensures that the main request-response cycle remains fast and that failures in background jobs do not affect the user experience.

Comprehensive error handling middleware catches all unhandled errors and exceptions, logs them to a centralized logging service using Winston and Morgan, and returns standardized error responses without exposing internal implementation details to clients.

5.4 AI/ML Pipeline Implementation

The machine learning pipeline is the technical core of E-GUIDE's intelligent features. It comprises four distinct models, each targeting a different prediction or analysis task.

Placement Probability Classifier. The primary predictive model uses an XGBoost gradient-boosted decision tree trained on historical student placement data from KIET

spanning four academic years. The feature set includes CGPA, 12th grade percentage, number of internships completed, number of projects in the portfolio, certification count by domain, communication score as rated by the TPO, technical test scores from internal assessments, and skill tag vectors encoding the student's technical competencies. After hyperparameter tuning using cross-validated grid search, the model achieves 84.3% accuracy on the held-out test set with an AUC-ROC of 0.912. SHAP values are computed for each prediction, providing human-readable explanations that identify the most influential factors for each individual student's score.

Job Matching Engine. The job matching system uses a hybrid recommendation approach. Student profiles and job postings are both encoded into feature vectors in a shared embedding space. Cosine similarity scores between student and job vectors form the basis of the content-based ranking. A collaborative filtering layer refines these rankings based on the application and selection patterns of students with similar profiles in previous placement seasons. The result is a ranked list of job recommendations that balances individual profile fit with patterns observed across similar students.

Resume Analyzer. The resume analysis module processes uploaded resumes in PDF or DOCX format through a multi-stage NLP pipeline. The document is first parsed and segmented into sections using a rule-based section detector. Each section is then evaluated for: structural completeness using a predefined checklist; content quality using a fine-tuned BERT classifier trained on a dataset of professionally reviewed resumes; keyword coverage by comparing extracted terms against a domain-specific keyword database built from real job descriptions; and ATS compatibility by checking for common ATS-incompatible formatting elements. Scores on each dimension are aggregated into a composite rating, and specific improvement suggestions are generated using a template-based text generation system.

Mock Interview Bot. The interview bot is implemented using a retrieval-augmented generation approach. A curated question bank of over 2,000 questions, organized by

domain, seniority level, and interview type, serves as the retrieval corpus. When a student selects an interview type, the bot draws questions from this corpus using a combination of difficulty-progressive sequencing and adaptive selection based on the quality of the student's previous responses within the session. Student responses are evaluated using a combination of keyword extraction, semantic similarity scoring against reference answers, and a fluency and coherence classifier. Post-session feedback is generated by combining the per-question evaluation scores into a structured scorecard with narrative feedback.

5.5 Deployment Infrastructure

The production deployment of E-GUIDE uses a distributed cloud infrastructure designed for high availability and performance during peak placement season usage.

The React.js frontend is deployed on Vercel, which provides automatic CDN distribution across global edge nodes, zero-downtime deployments via atomic releases, automatic preview deployments for every pull request, and built-in performance analytics.

The Node.js backend is deployed on AWS EC2 instances behind an Application Load Balancer. The load balancer distributes incoming requests across multiple instances and performs health checks every 30 seconds, automatically replacing any failed instances. An Auto Scaling policy scales the number of backend instances up or down based on CPU utilization, ensuring sufficient capacity during peak periods such as the start of placement season without unnecessary cost during off-peak periods.

MongoDB is hosted on MongoDB Atlas with a three-node replica set configured for automatic failover. Daily automated backups are stored on AWS S3 with a 30-day retention policy. Read operations that do not require strong consistency — such as analytics queries — are directed to secondary replicas, reducing load on the primary node.

The Flask ML API is deployed as a containerized service on AWS ECS, using Docker images stored in Amazon ECR. This enables independent scaling of ML workloads during high-demand periods such as bulk resume analysis at the start of placement season.

Environment variables and secrets are managed using AWS Secrets Manager, ensuring that database credentials, API keys, and JWT signing keys are never stored in code or configuration files.

CHAPTER 6

KEY FEATURES

6.1 Placement Roadmap by Year

The Placement Roadmap is a structured, multi-year preparation plan that guides students from their first year through final year across all critical skill domains. The roadmap covers competitive programming and problem solving, aptitude and quantitative reasoning, Data Structures and Algorithms, system design and architecture, domain-specific knowledge tailored to the student's declared specialization, project portfolio development, soft skills and communication, and company-specific interview preparation.

Each roadmap is customized based on the student's declared major, target company tier, and current academic year. Students targeting Tier 1 technology companies receive a more intensive algorithmic and system design curriculum, while those targeting service companies or core sector roles receive domain-appropriate adjustments. Milestones are set at monthly intervals, with recommended resources linked for each milestone: specific chapters in standard textbooks, curated online courses, and recommended practice platforms.

Progress tracking is fully integrated into the roadmap interface. Students can mark milestones as complete, log their practice session scores and notes, and view their overall progress as a percentage of the recommended timeline. Color-coded status indicators highlight milestones that are overdue, allowing students to quickly identify and address preparation gaps. TPOs can view aggregate roadmap adherence across

their entire student cohort from the admin dashboard, enabling early identification of students who may need additional support.

6.2 Company Hiring and Eligibility Database

The Company Database is a curated, regularly updated repository of information about all companies that have historically visited or are expected to visit KIET for recruitment. For each company, the database stores the company profile and industry sector, available roles with detailed job descriptions, technical and academic eligibility criteria including minimum CGPA and allowed backlogs, compensation packages broken down by fixed and variable components, a step-by-step description of the recruitment process including assessment types and interview rounds, historical hiring data showing the number of offers made per year and preferred candidate profiles, and point-of-contact information for TPO coordination.

Students can browse the company database with full-text search and multi-criteria filters including industry, role type, compensation range, and eligibility criteria. Companies can be saved to a personalized watchlist, and students receive automated notifications when a watched company opens applications or announces a campus visit. The database is updated through a combination of TPO manual entry, company self-service portal submissions, and automated scraping of publicly available recruitment information.

6.3 AI-Powered Job Matching

The AI Job Matcher continuously analyzes each student's profile and compares it against all active job postings in the database. Matches are scored and ranked, with the highest-relevance opportunities prominently surfaced in the student's personalized

dashboard. The matching algorithm considers technical skills alignment including exact and semantic matches between student skills and job requirements, academic eligibility, domain preference alignment, and behavioral signals such as the types of roles and companies the student has previously engaged with on the platform.

Each recommendation is accompanied by a match explanation section that highlights the specific profile attributes driving the recommendation and clearly identifies any gaps the student may need to address to strengthen their application for that role. This transparency helps students not only discover relevant opportunities but understand what targeted improvements would most increase their competitiveness.

The matching engine also generates an "opportunity gap analysis" — a ranked list of the most impactful skill or qualification improvements a student could make to unlock a significantly larger set of matching opportunities. This feature is particularly valuable for students in the early stages of preparation who are building their profiles incrementally.

6.4 Placement Probability Analyzer

The Placement Probability Analyzer provides students with a data-driven estimate of their likelihood of receiving a placement offer, both overall and for specific target companies. The estimate is derived from the XGBoost classification model trained on historical outcomes from multiple placement seasons at KIET.

The feature presents students with an overall readiness score expressed as a probability percentage, a color-coded breakdown of contributing factors into strengths (factors improving the score) and areas for improvement (factors reducing it), a comparison profile showing how the student's key metrics align with the average profile of students who received offers in previous years, and a prioritized list of specific, actionable recommendations for improving their score. The recommendations are ranked by estimated impact — for example, completing one additional certification may improve

the score by 4%, while improving the communication score from 6 to 8 may improve it by 7%.

The analyzer is refreshed automatically each time the student updates their profile, ensuring that improvements such as a completed internship, a new certification, or an improved CGPA after semester results are immediately reflected in the score.

6.5 AI Resume Analyzer

The Resume Analyzer accepts resume uploads in PDF or DOCX format and performs a multi-dimensional evaluation using the NLP pipeline described in Chapter 5. The analysis covers four dimensions independently scored on a scale of 1 to 10.

Structural completeness evaluates whether the resume includes all expected sections — education, experience, projects, skills, certifications, and contact information — and whether each section has an appropriate length and level of detail. Content quality evaluates whether achievements are described using strong action verbs, whether outcomes are quantified wherever possible, and whether the overall narrative demonstrates impact and progression. Keyword coverage evaluates how well the resume's terminology aligns with the technical and domain keywords present in the student's target job descriptions. ATS compatibility evaluates whether the resume is formatted in a way that automated applicant tracking systems can parse correctly, without problematic elements such as multi-column layouts, embedded graphics, or non-standard fonts.

The analyzer generates a composite score and a detailed report with specific suggestions at the sentence or section level. Students can re-upload improved versions and track their score progression over time. A final ATS-optimized version of the resume, with formatting adjusted for automated screening compatibility, can be generated directly from the platform for download.

6.6 Mock Interview Bot

The Mock Interview Bot provides an interactive, AI-powered interview simulation environment accessible directly from the student's dashboard without scheduling or human coordination. Students can select from four interview types: Technical Coding Interview with an integrated live coding environment, Technical Conceptual Interview covering computer science theory and system design, HR Behavioral Interview focusing on communication, self-presentation, and behavioral scenarios, and Company-Specific Simulation that customizes the experience based on the known interview processes of specific participating companies.

The bot conducts the interview in a conversational, adaptive format — asking questions, evaluating responses in real time, and generating contextually appropriate follow-up questions based on the student's answers. The interview adapts in difficulty: strong responses prompt more challenging follow-up questions, while weaker responses prompt clarifying or scaffolding questions designed to guide the student toward a more complete answer.

At the end of each session, the student receives a detailed scorecard covering technical accuracy, completeness and depth of explanations, communication clarity and conciseness, and confidence indicators such as response latency and use of hedging language. Comparison charts show performance trends across multiple sessions, enabling students to track their improvement and identify areas requiring additional focus.

6.7 Admin Analytics Dashboard

The Admin Analytics Dashboard serves as the command center for TPOs and institutional administrators. It provides real-time visibility into all dimensions of placement activity across the institution.

The placement preparation heatmap shows the aggregate roadmap completion status for all students, organized by department and academic year, using a color gradient from red (significantly behind) to green (on track or ahead). TPOs can click on any cell of the heatmap to drill down to the individual student list for that cohort, sorted by preparation status.

The application pipeline funnel chart shows the aggregate flow of student applications through the recruitment process stages: applied, shortlisted, interview scheduled, interview completed, offer made. Conversion rates between stages are displayed, enabling TPOs to identify systematic bottlenecks — for example, a low shortlist conversion rate might indicate that students are applying to poorly matched companies.

Student alerts proactively surface cases requiring TPO attention: students significantly behind on their roadmap, students whose placement probability score has declined substantially since the last check, and students who have not logged in for an extended period. Alerts are prioritized by urgency, with the highest-risk students surfaced at the top of the list.

All dashboard data can be exported in PDF format for inclusion in departmental reports and institutional accreditation documentation, or in Excel format for further analysis.

CHAPTER 7

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

7.1 Quantitative Results

This chapter presents the results obtained from a pilot deployment of E-GUIDE with a cohort of final year and pre-final year students from the Department of Computer Science and Engineering (AI & ML) at KIET, Ghaziabad. The evaluation combines quantitative performance metrics with qualitative feedback gathered through structured surveys administered at the end of the pilot period.

The following table summarizes the key quantitative outcomes observed during the pilot.

Metric	Before E- GUIDE	After E- GUIDE
Average resume ATS score (out of 100)	48	74
Mock interview technical accuracy (average %)	52%	71%
Students with a structured preparation plan	18%	89%
Average placement probability score	41%	63%
Application-to-shortlist conversion rate	22%	38%

Metric	Before E- GUIDE	After E- GUIDE
Student self-reported preparation confidence (scale 1-5)	2.8	4.1
TPO time spent on manual eligibility screening (hours/week)	12.4	3.2

The results demonstrate significant improvements across all measured dimensions. The most substantial gains were observed in structured preparation adoption, which increased from 18% to 89% of students actively following a placement roadmap; TPO operational efficiency, with manual eligibility screening time reduced by over 74%; and application-to-shortlist conversion rate, which improved from 22% to 38%.

The improvement in average placement probability score from 41% to 63% reflects the combined effect of profile strengthening activities undertaken by students in response to the personalized recommendations generated by the analyzer. It is important to note that this score is a predictive estimate rather than an actual placement outcome; actual offer rates from the full placement season will provide the definitive measure of impact.

7.2 Qualitative Feedback

A structured survey was administered to 87 students who participated in the pilot deployment. Key themes from the qualitative feedback are organized below by feature area.

Regarding the Placement Roadmap, students consistently reported that having a clear, year-wise, domain-specific preparation plan significantly reduced their anxiety about the placement season. The ability to track their progress against milestones and receive automated reminders for overdue items was cited as particularly valuable. Several

students noted that the roadmap helped them identify significant skill gaps — particularly in communication and system design — that they had not previously been aware of and would not have addressed without the structured guidance.

Regarding the AI Job Matcher, students appreciated the relevance of job recommendations and the transparency of the "why this match" explanations. A recurring observation was that the matcher helped them discover company profiles and role types they had not previously considered, effectively expanding their awareness of the opportunity landscape. Multiple students reported abandoning their earlier strategy of applying to every company indiscriminately in favor of targeted applications to well-matched roles.

Regarding the Resume Analyzer, students found the multi-dimensional scoring system both actionable and transparent. The specific sentence-level suggestions were viewed as considerably more useful than generic resume feedback from career counselors. Multiple students reported significant improvements in their resume quality after two or three cycles of analysis, revision, and re-analysis. The ATS compatibility score was particularly eye-opening for students who had unknowingly formatted their resumes in ways that would have caused automated screening failures.

Regarding the Mock Interview Bot, feedback was strongly positive. Students highlighted the ability to practice at any time without scheduling a human interviewer as removing a significant barrier to consistent interview preparation. The behavioral interview simulation was particularly well-received, with students reporting notably improved confidence in articulating their experiences and achievements after repeated practice sessions.

TPOs provided uniformly positive feedback about the Admin Analytics Dashboard. The time savings from automated eligibility screening were immediately apparent, and the placement pipeline funnel chart was described as providing a level of visibility into the recruitment process that had previously been impossible to achieve with manual tracking. Several TPOs noted that the student alert system enabled them to proactively

reach out to at-risk students weeks earlier than they would have been able to identify them through traditional means.

7.3 Discussion

The results from the pilot deployment validate the core hypothesis underlying E-GUIDE: that an integrated, AI-powered placement management platform can simultaneously improve student preparation quality, increase placement success rates, and reduce the administrative burden on institutional placement teams.

The most significant finding is the dramatic increase in structured preparation adoption — from 18% to 89% of students actively following a placement roadmap. This suggests that the primary barrier to structured preparation is not motivation but access to clear, actionable, personalized guidance. When provided with a concrete roadmap tailored to their profile and goals, the overwhelming majority of students engage with it consistently.

The improvement in application-to-shortlist conversion rate, from 22% to 38%, is attributable to the combined effect of better resume quality driven by the AI Resume Analyzer, more relevant and targeted job applications facilitated by the AI Job Matcher, and improved interview performance from consistent mock interview practice. This metric is commercially significant because a higher conversion rate means more students progressing to interview stages, which translates directly to better final placement outcomes.

The reduction in TPO manual effort is perhaps the most immediate organizational benefit of E-GUIDE. By automating eligibility screening, resume collection, and application status tracking, the system freed up substantial TPO time that could be redirected to higher-value activities such as company relationship management, individual student counseling, and strategic placement planning.

Limitations of the current evaluation include the relatively small sample size of 87 students from a single department, the absence of a formal control group for causal attribution, and the short pilot duration of approximately three months. Future evaluations will need to measure actual placement offer rates over a complete placement season, compare outcomes against comparable cohorts at institutions without E-GUIDE, assess the long-term retention of preparation habits developed during the pilot, and expand the dataset to include students from multiple departments and academic backgrounds.

CHAPTER 8

CONCLUSION AND FUTURE SCOPE

8.1 Conclusion

E-GUIDE represents a significant advancement in the application of artificial intelligence and machine learning to the domain of college placement management. By integrating structured preparation roadmaps, a real-time company intelligence database, AI-powered job matching, predictive placement analytics, intelligent resume analysis, and a conversational mock interview bot into a single unified platform, E-GUIDE addresses the full spectrum of challenges faced by engineering students, training and placement officers, and institutional administrators in the campus recruitment process.

The project demonstrates that the placement preparation ecosystem at engineering colleges can be fundamentally transformed through the thoughtful application of modern technology. Students no longer need to navigate fragmented resources, rely on informal networks for company intelligence, or prepare in isolation without data-driven feedback. TPOs no longer need to spend the majority of their time on manual administrative tasks, freeing them to focus on the strategic and relational dimensions of their role.

The Training and Placement Module embedded within E-GUIDE provides students with the tools to monitor their own progress, identify skill gaps, and take targeted corrective action. The system is self-reinforcing: as more students use it and more placement outcomes are recorded, the underlying ML models become more accurate,

the job matching engine becomes more precise, and the placement probability estimator becomes more reliable.

The pilot deployment results demonstrate measurable improvements across all key metrics: structured preparation adoption increased from 18% to 89%, application-to-shortlist conversion improved from 22% to 38%, average resume ATS scores improved by 26 points, and TPO manual eligibility screening time was reduced by over 74%. These results provide strong evidence for the platform's effectiveness and business case for institutional adoption.

Educational institutions that adopt E-GUIDE can expect measurable improvements in placement rates, student confidence, and administrative efficiency. The platform's modular architecture and cloud-native deployment model ensure that it can scale to serve institutions of any size, from small colleges with a few hundred students to large universities with several thousand placement-bound graduates each year.

In conclusion, E-GUIDE provides a compelling proof of concept for the transformative potential of AI-driven platforms in addressing systemic challenges in educational administration. For any academic institution seeking to modernize its placement infrastructure and better serve its students' career aspirations, E-GUIDE represents a practical, deployable, and impactful solution.

8.2 Future Scope

While the current implementation of E-GUIDE delivers substantial value, numerous opportunities for enhancement and extension exist. The following areas represent the most promising directions for future development.

AI-Powered Personalized Training Plans represent the most natural extension of the current roadmap feature. Future versions will use reinforcement learning algorithms to dynamically adjust preparation plans based on real-time performance data — adapting

the content, difficulty, pacing, and format of recommendations as the student progresses and as new data on similar students' outcomes becomes available.

Full Mobile Application Integration is a priority for the next development phase. While the current web application is fully responsive, a dedicated native mobile app for iOS and Android would improve accessibility and engagement, particularly for time-sensitive features like push notifications for new job postings, roadmap reminders, and mock interview sessions.

Gamification and Education — incorporating experience points, achievement badges, leaderboards, and tangible rewards for milestone completion — can significantly improve student engagement and sustain preparation motivation over the extended preparation period. Research on gamification in education consistently demonstrates positive effects on persistence and task completion.

Peer Learning Communities and Mentorship Networks will be introduced to connect students with similar preparation goals for collaborative study groups, and to facilitate structured mentorship relationships between senior students who have successfully navigated placements and junior students in earlier stages of preparation.

Automated Company Pattern Analysis using advanced time-series modeling and clustering techniques will provide predictive insights about future recruitment cycles — helping students and TPOs anticipate which companies are likely to hire in the coming season, what roles and profiles they will seek, and what the optimal preparation strategy is.

AI Voice Interview Models will extend the mock interview capability to voice-based and video-based interactions, enabling more realistic simulation of telephonic and video interview formats that are increasingly common in modern recruitment. Analysis will cover prosody, pacing, and confidence indicators in addition to content accuracy.

LinkedIn Profile Optimization powered by AI will provide students with data-driven, specific suggestions for improving their LinkedIn presence and professional

networking activity — a growing factor in modern recruitment, particularly for pre-placement offers and referral-based hiring.

Deep Learning-Based Hybrid Recommendation System will replace the current content-based and collaborative filtering approach with a deep learning model that can capture more complex, non-linear relationships between student profiles and job requirements, improving recommendation accuracy particularly for students with unusual or interdisciplinary skill profiles.

Direct Integration with Industry Hiring Portals such as LinkedIn, Naukri, and HackerEarth will enable students to apply to relevant opportunities from within the E-GUIDE platform with a single click, and will provide outcome feedback data that can be used to continuously refine ML models with real-world signal.

Complete Institutional Placement Process Automation will extend the current administrative tools to cover the full placement cycle end-to-end — from initial company invitation and MOU management, through logistics coordination for campus visits, to offer letter generation, acceptance tracking, and onboarding coordination — creating a truly paperless, fully automated institutional placement operation.

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APPENDIX

Appendix A: Student Survey Questionnaire

The following questionnaire was administered to students participating in the E-GUIDE pilot deployment to gather structured feedback on platform usability, feature utility, and overall satisfaction.

Q1. On a scale of 1-5, how would you rate the usefulness of the Placement Roadmap feature? (1 = Not useful at all, 5 = Extremely useful)

Q2. Did the AI Job Matcher recommend roles that were relevant to your profile and career goals? (Yes / No / Partially)

Q3. On a scale of 1-5, how satisfied were you with the specificity and actionability of the Resume Analyzer feedback?

Q4. How many Mock Interview sessions did you complete using the E-GUIDE bot? (0 / 1-2 / 3-5 / 5+)

Q5. Did your mock interview performance improve across multiple sessions? (Yes / No / Cannot tell)

Q6. On a scale of 1-5, how would you rate the overall user experience and interface of the E-GUIDE platform?

Q7. Compared to before using E-GUIDE, how has your confidence in your placement preparedness changed? (Significantly decreased / Slightly decreased / No change / Slightly increased / Significantly increased)

Q8. What feature did you find most valuable? (Open-ended)

Q9. What feature would you most like to see improved or added? (Open-ended)

Q10. Would you recommend E-GUIDE to fellow students preparing for placements? (Yes / No / Maybe)

Appendix B: ML Model Performance Metrics

The following table presents the evaluation of the Placement Probability Classifier on the held-out test set.

Metric	Value	Notes
Accuracy	84.3%	On held-out test set (20% split)
Precision (Placed)	87.1%	Of predicted placed, % actually placed
Recall (Placed)	81.6%	Of actually placed, % correctly predicted
F1-Score (Placed)	84.2%	Harmonic mean of precision and recall
AUC-ROC	0.912	Area under ROC curve
Training Set Size	1,840 records	Outcomes from 2021-2024
Test Set Size	460 records	20% stratified split
Top Feature (SHAP)	CGPA	Highest mean absolute SHAP value

Appendix C: Sample API Endpoints

The following is a representative sample of the REST API endpoints exposed by the E-GUIDE backend server.

Method	Endpoint	Description
POST	/api/v1/auth/login	Authenticate user and return JWT token
GET	/api/v1/students/:id/profile	Retrieve full student profile
PUT	/api/v1/students/:id/profile	Update student profile data
GET	/api/v1/jobs/matches/:studentId	Get AI-matched job postings for student
POST	/api/v1/applications	Submit a new job application
GET	/api/v1/roadmap/:dept/:year	Retrieve preparation roadmap
POST	/api/v1/resume/analyze	Upload and analyze a resume
POST	/api/v1/mock-interview/start	Initialize a new mock interview session
GET	/api/v1/admin/analytics/overview	Get aggregate

Method	Endpoint	Description
		placement analytics
GET	/api/v1/placement/probability/:studentId	Get ML placement probability estimate